



OCEAN RACERS

While tuna hunt in packs, the big predators, known as billfish, hunt alone. These include marlins, sailfish, and swordfish. They all have long, bony, sharp-pointed upper jaws, or bills. Like tuna, they are built for speed, but many are even faster. The sailfish folds away its big sail-like dorsal fin when it is swimming fast. It travels huge distances through the ocean in search of prey.

◀ SAILFISH

These fish are found near the ocean surface, targeting schools of fish. But they will also prey on squid and octopus.

FORMIDABLE PREDATORS

The swordfish has an acute sense of vision and the longest, sharpest bill of all. Like the other billfish, it uses its powerful muscles to slice through the water at an incredible speed as it chases after smaller fish and squid. When it overtakes its prey, the swordfish sometimes uses its long bill to slash at its victims, stunning or injuring them so they are easier to catch.

▼ SWORDFISH

The sharp bill of the swordfish makes a useful weapon when attacking a fast-moving, dense ball of fish, but its main job is to make the swordfish perfectly streamlined.

Swordlike bill pierces water as fish rockets after its prey

Smooth skin has no scales to slow it down



FEEDING FRENZY

When this oceanic hunter runs into a school of fish, it accelerates to strike at high speed, giving its victims little chance of escape. Tuna launch a mass attack, snapping at anything that moves. Prey fish often try to hide behind each other to avoid being picked out, forming a tightly packed, swirling mass. They may even try to get away by bursting up through the ocean surface.

◀ HERRING PREY

Herded together by the frenzied attack of a school of hungry tuna, herrings leap into the air in a desperate bid to escape.